I can do. I don't want to show which shape I can make, I want the wood/material and the pen kits to speak for themselves. So the shape is simple, but exact. After making a few pens in wood, I began searching for other materials to use. I found materials like multiplex in all different cuts, buffalo horn, soapstone, cholla cactus and hybrid pen blanks made from mallee burl, mini cones and so on. Also I pay close attention to the exactness and the finish.

When making pens from the cholla cactus wood, it's only dried and not stabilised. I trill it, glue the messing in, turn it and just before I'm finished with turning, I put the coloured stones with glue in it and then the work begins. I start sanding with 80 grit, ending with 1,000 grit, before I put the finish with cyanoacrylate on it. This takes a lot of time and makes the pen very expensive. But the result is unique and the look is unbelievable

What inspires you?

All of my finished pens: they are all my babies and I don't want to sell them, but I do so I can make more. For me, it's like an obsession. To make pens gives me the quiet and power I need. I'm glad I found my way back to my roots

Who or what has been your greatest influence?

My wonderful wife gave me all my influence because she gave me all the freedom I need and she is the best adviser I can ever have

Tell us about your workshop

I have a small workshop which is about 25m sq. There I have all the machines I need: my Killinger 1400 SE, a Wood Rat, all electric hand tools like upper mill, a bandsaw, cutting saw and a wet sharpening machine. I try to make things with minimal expenses and equipment, but with the best I can get. My timber yard is separate, in another room which is dry and warm, so I constantly can use good dried wood for making the fine pens

Where do you see yourself heading?

I want to be more and more self-sufficient and to try using more materials without any financial risk

What have been the highs and lows of your career so far?

The high in my career is to have had the opportunity to start again with woodturning, after so many years. The low was to find the way back into it, which was full of bumps in the road but without this, I never could enjoy where I am now

What is the best thing about turning?

You get the chance to go into yourself and become one with the piece of wood and the lathe. It gives me the quiet and the power I need in this fast running world

Jürgen Heid at his lathe, testing if the parts fit exactly together

Starting to turn cholla cactus wood: small turquoise stones will be later glued into the holes

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